GATE
All Branches

Verbal Aptitude



Reading Comprehension & Miscellaneous

Lecture No. - 02



By- Ashutosh Sir

Topics to be Covered



- Topic
- Topic
- Topic
- Topic
- Topic

Reading Comprehension & Miscellaneous

Adjective → noun/pronoun

Adverbs → verb, adjective, adverb



Topic : Part of speech

Adverbs:

1. Adverb must be placed as near as possible to the word it modifies.

X----------She just wants to take one class.

She wants to take just one class.



Topic : Part of speech

2. when a verb consist of an auxiliary and a main verb then Adverb is placed in between them.

X----------I have told him often not to come late.

I have often told him not to come late.

Time stamping

Verb

Auxiliary Verb

Main Verb → Action



Topic : Part of speech

3. The word "Only" should be placed before the word it modifies.

X----------I only solved two problems

I solved only two problems.



Topic : Part of speech

4. When used as Adverb, Some words have a different meaning.

Hard-------Diligently

Hardly-------- Scarcely, barely

very less possibility



Topic : Part of speech

Verb:

1. when two subjects are joined by “and”, the verb is plural.

eg: My friend and his father are in Japan.



Topic : Part of speech

2. when two singular nouns are joined by "and" refer to the same person or thing, the verb is singular.

eg: The district magistrate and Collector is on leave today.

The secretary and the president have been given warm welcome.

IAS → DM / Collector

↓ law & order

↘ Revenue



Topic : Part of speech

3. If two different nouns express one idea, the verb should be in singular form.

eg: Bread and milk is good for breakfast.

Rice and curry is my favourite dish.



Topic : Part of speech

4. When two singular subjects are practically synonymous the verb should be in singular form.

eg: His power and influence is on the rise.

Peace and prosperity is the need of the day.



Topic : Part of speech

5. If two singular subjects are preceded by "each" & "every", the verb should be in singular.

eg: Every boy and girl was present in the class yesterday.

Every man and every woman has the right to apply for the job.



Topic : Part of speech

6. None/No

- None can take either singular or plural verb depending on the noun which follows it.

None of the counterfeit money has been found.

None of the students have finished the exam yet.

- No can take singular and plural verb depending on the noun which follows it.

No example is relevant to this situation.

No examples are relevant to this situation.



Topic : Part of speech

7 Majority:

Majority can be singular or plural
If it is alone it is usually singular.
If it is followed by a plural noun, it is usually plural.

entity

eg: The majority believes that the situation is dramatic.

The majority of the students were protesting.



Topic : Part of speech

8. When "a lot of", "a great deal of", "plenty of", "most of" and "some of"

When refer to number then plural verb is used.

eg: A lot of people were present in the party.

When refer to an amount, the verb is singular.

eg: A lot of work has to be completed before we leave.



Topic : Part of speech

➤ **Preposition:** → noun / pronoun → relate

1. some words with prepositions require gerund (A **gerund** is any of various nonfinite verb forms in various languages; most often, but not exclusively, one that functions as a noun.) after them.

to avoid ← Refrain from hurting

to restrict ← Prevent from working

Tired of writing

love ← Fond of playing

excuse ← Pretext for delaying

Succeed in doing

Abstain from drinking

work (verb) + ing = working

Abstain → not allowing oneself to have physical pleasure.



Topic : Part of speech

help

Aid at doing

Bent upon doing

Adverse to playing → oppose, not favourable.

Expert in inventing

Desist from talking → Resist

Capable of playing

Insist on going



Topic : Part of speech

2. In & Within

- In refers to end of a period of time usually in future.

eg: He will return in a month.

- Within means before the end of the period of time.

eg: He will return within a month.



Topic : Part of speech

3. In & Into

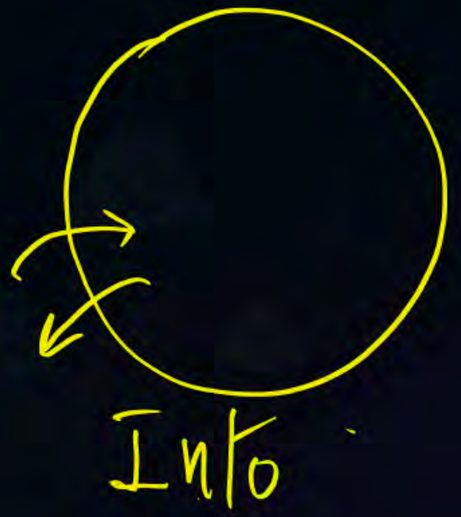
- In indicated rest or motion inside anything

eg: She is in the garden
She is walking in the garden.



- Into means motion towards the inside of anything.

eg: He walked into the garden.
They broke into my house yesterday.





Topic : Part of speech

4. On is used

- In speaking of things in rest

eg: He sat on a big stone.

- Before the names of days and dates

eg: On Friday, On the 2nd of August.

- To denote support and concern

eg: He wrote books on philosophy.



Topic : Part of speech

5 Upon is used in speaking of things in motion.

eg: The ~~tigers~~ sprang upon the goat.

Tiger

+ Transition

on → rest

upon → motion

6. Beside means 'by the side of'

Besides means 'in addition to'



Topic : Part of speech

7. Between & Among

Between is used for two persons or things.

Among is used for more than two persons or things.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

→ very less possibility, less frequency.

18. Hardly, Scarcely, rarely, Seldom, Without, & Only

- Scarcely & Hardly are followed by "when" and not "than" ✗
- No sooner is followed by "than"
- ☆ No sooner + had + Subject + Past participle + ...

eg: No sooner had I reached the station than the train left.

- ☆ No sooner + did + subject + present tense verb + ...

No sooner did I reach the station than the train left.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

sense → see, hear, touch, smell, taste

19. Some verbs related to sensation are followed by adjectives not by adverbs

eg: feel, look, seem, appear, smell, taste and sound

X---------He feels badly.

He feels bad.

X---------The soup smells deliciously.

The soup smells delicious



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

Adverbs:

1. Adverb must be placed as near as possible to the word it modifies.

X----------She just wants to take one class.

She wants to take <u>just</u> one class.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

2. when a verb consist of an auxiliary and a main verb then Adverb is placed in between them.

X----------I have told him often not to come late.

I have <u>often</u> told him not to come late.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

3. The word “Only” should be placed before the word it modifies.

X----------I only solved two problems

I solved only two problems.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

4. When used as Adverb, Some words have a different meaning.

Hard-------Diligently

Hardly------- Scarcely, barely



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

Verb:

1. when two subjects are joined by “and”, the verb is plural.

eg: My friend and his father are in Japan.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

2. when two singular nouns are joined by “and” refer to the same person or thing, the verb is singular.

eg: The district magistrate and Collector <u>is</u> on leave today.

The secretary and the president <u>have</u> been given warm welcome.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

3. If two different nouns express one idea, the verb should be in singular form.

eg: Bread and milk <u>is</u> good for breakfast.

Rice and curry <u>is</u> my favourite dish.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

4. When two singular subjects are practically synonymous the verb should be in singular form.

eg: His power and influence is on the rise.

Peace and prosperity is the need of the day.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

5. If two singular subjects are preceded by “each” & “every”, the verb should be in singular.

eg: Every boy and girl <u>was</u> present in the class yesterday.

Every man and every woman <u>has</u> the right to apply for the job.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

6. None/No

- None can take either singular or plural verb depending on the noun which follows it.

None of the counterfeit money has been found.

None of the students have finished the exam yet.

- No can take singular and plural verb depending on the noun which follows it.

No example is relevant to this situation.

No examples are relevant to this situation.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

7 Majority:

Majority can be singular or plural
If it is alone it is usually singular.
If it is followed by a plural noun, it is usually plural.

eg: The majority <u>believes</u> that the situation is dramatic.

The majority of the students <u>were</u> protesting.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

8. When "a lot of", "a great deal of", "plenty of", "most of" and "some of"

When refer to number then plural verb is used.

eg: A lot of people <u>were</u> present in the party.

When refer to an amount, the verb is singular.

eg: A lot of work <u>has</u> to be completed before we leave.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

➢ **Preposition:**

1. some words with prepositions require gerund (A **gerund** is any of various nonfinite verb forms in various languages; most often, but not exclusively, one that functions as a noun.) after them.

Refrain from hurting
Prevent from working
Tired of writing
Fond of playing
Pretext for delaying
Succeed in doing
Abstain from drinking



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

Aid at doing

Bent upon doing

Adverse to playing

Expert in inventing

Desist from talking

Capable of playing

Insist on going



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

2. In & Within

- In refers to end of a period of time usually in future.

eg: He will return in a month.

- Within means before the end of the period of time.

eg: He will return within a month.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

3. In & Into

- In indicated rest or motion inside anything

eg: She is <u>in</u> the garden
She is walking <u>in</u> the garden.

- Into means motion towards the inside of anything.

eg: He walked <u>into</u> the garden.
They broke <u>into</u> my house yesterday.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

4. On is used

- In speaking of things in rest

eg: He sat on a big stone.

- Before the names of days and dates

eg: On Friday, On the 2nd of August.

- To denote support and concern

eg: He wrote books <u>on</u> philosophy.



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

5 Upon is used in speaking of things in motion.

eg: The tigers sprang upon the goat.

6. Beside means 'by the side of'

Besides means 'in addition to'



Topic : Vocabulary Part-1

7. Between & Among

Between is used for two persons or things.

Among is used for more than two persons or things.

- **Verb:**

1. when two subjects are joined by “and”, the verb is plural.

eg: My friend and his father are in Japan.

2. when two singular nouns are joined by “and” refer to the same person or thing, the verb is singular.

eg: The district magistrate and Collector <u>is</u> on leave today.

The secretary and the president <u>have</u> been given warm welcome.

3. If two different nouns express one idea, the verb should be in singular form.

eg: Bread and milk <u>is</u> good for breakfast.

Rice and curry <u>is</u> my favourite dish.

4. When two singular subjects are practically synonymous the verb should be in singular form.

eg: His power and influence is on the rise.

Peace and prosperity is the need of the day.

5. If two singular subjects are preceded by “each” & “every”, the verb should be in singular.

eg: Every boy and girl <u>was</u> present in the class yesterday.

Every man and every woman <u>has</u> the right to apply for the job.

6. None/No

- None can take either singular or plural verb depending on the noun which follows it.

None of the counterfeit money has been found.

None of the students have finished the exam yet.

- No can take singular and plural verb depending on the noun which follows it.

No example is relevant to this situation.

No examples are relevant to this situation.

7 Majority:

Majority can be singular or plural
If it is alone it is usually singular.
If it is followed by a plural noun, it is usually plural.

eg: The majority <u>believes</u> that the situation is dramatic.

The majority of the students <u>were</u> protesting.

8. When “a lot of”, “a great deal of”, “plenty of”, “most of” and “some of”

When refer to number then plural verb is used.

eg: A lot of people <u>were</u> present in the party.

When refer to an amount, the verb is singular.

eg: A lot of work <u>has</u> to be completed before we leave.

Then → time

Than → comparison



Topic : Reading Comprehesion

Conditionals:

If

If clause.....Main Clause

If + Present.....Future

If + Past.....Would + verb

If + Past perfect.....Would + have + past participle

had + verb 3rd



Topic : Reading Comprehesion

If he comes to the library, I will give him these books.

If she came to my house, I would give her your message.

If she had come to my house, I would have given her your message.

If he will come to the library, I will give him books.



Topic : Reading Comprehesion

If + desire/hypothetical condition

If + were, irrespective of previous rules.

eg. If I were a bird, I would fly to Australia.



Topic : Reading Comprehesion

eg. If I will win the contest, I will buy a new house.

If I win the contest, I will buy a new house.

eg. If I would have been there, I would make a speech.

If I had been there, I would have made a speech.

or, If I were there, I would make a speech.

eg. If I would have a degree from that university, I would get a good job.

If I had a degree from that university, I would get a good job.



Topic : Vocabulary-2

exacerbate

make worse

exculpate

pronounce not guilty of criminal charges

exigency

a pressing or urgent situation



Topic : Vocabulary-2

extrapolation

an inference about the future based on known facts

facetious

cleverly amusing in tone

facilitate

make easier



Topic : Vocabulary-2

fallacious

containing or based on incorrect reasoning

fatuous

devoid of intelligence



Topic : Vocabulary-2

fawning

attempting to win favor by flattery

felicitous

exhibiting an agreeably appropriate manner or style

fervor

feelings of great warmth and intensity



Topic : Vocabulary-2

flag

a rectangular piece of cloth of distinctive design

fledgling

young bird that has just become capable of flying



Topic : Vocabulary-2

flout

treat with contemptuous disregard

foment

try to stir up

forestall

keep from happening or arising; make impossible



Topic : Vocabulary-2

frugality

prudence in avoiding waste

futile

producing no result or effect



Topic : Vocabulary-2

gainsay

take exception to

garrulous

full of trivial conversation

goad

stab or urge on as if with a pointed stick



Topic : Vocabulary-2

gouge

an impression in a surface, as made by a blow

grandiloquent

lofty in style

#Q.1 Which of the following is CORRECT with respect to grammar and usage? Mount Everest is

A The highest peak in the world

B Highest peak in the world

C One of highest peak in the world

D One of the highest peak in the world

#Q.2 After India's cricket world cup victory in 1983 , Shrotria who was playing both tennis and cricket till then, decided to concentrate only on cricket. And the rest is history.

What does the underlined phrase mean in this context?

A History will rest in peace

B Rest is recorded in history books

C Rest is well known

D Rest is archaic

#Q.3 She has a sharp tongue and it can occasionally turn ____

A Hurtful

B Left ✗

C Methodical → conventional, less towards change.

D Vital → essential

#Q.4 "Indian history was written by British historians extremely well documented and researched, but not always impartial. History had to serve its purpose: Everything was made subservient to the glory of the Union Jack. Latter-day Indian scholar presented a contrary picture."
From the text above, we can infer that :
Indian history written by British historians

A was well documented and not researched but was always biased

B was not well documented and researched and was sometimes biased

C was well documented and researched but was sometimes biased

D was not well documented and researched and was always biased

#Q.5 The boat arrived…….

A on

B at

C under

D in

#Q.6 The strategies that the company ..... to sell its products .....house-to-house marketing.

A uses, include

B use, includes

C uses, including

D used, includes

#Q.7 A coastal region with unparalleled beauty is home to many species of animals. It is dotted with coral reefs and unspoilt white sandy beaches. It has remained inaccessible to tourists due to poor connectivity and lack of accommodation. A company has spotted the opportunity and is planning to develop a luxury resort with helicopter service to the nearest major city airport. Environmentalists are upset that this would lead to the region becoming crowded and polluted like any other major beach resorts. Which one of the following statements can be logically inferred from the information given in the above paragraph?

A The culture and tradition of the local people will be influenced by the tourists.

B The region will become crowded and polluted due to tourism.

C The coral reefs are on the decline and could soon vanish.

D Helicopter connectivity would lead to an increase in tourists coming to the region.

#Q.8 "Even though there is a vast scope for .....,its tourism has remained a/an .....area."
The words that best fill the blanks in the above sentence are

A improvement, neglected

B rejection, approved

C fame, glum

D interest, disinterested

#Q.9 "By giving him the last ..... of the cake, you will ensure lasting ..... in our house today."

The words that best fill the blanks in the above sentence are

A peas, piece

B piece, peace

C peace, piece

D peace, peas

#Q.10 Social science disciplines were in existence in an amorphous form until the colonial period when they were institutionalized. In varying degrees, they were intended to further the colonial interest. In the time of globalization and the economic rise of postcolonial countries like India, conventional ways of knowledge production have become obsolete. Which of the following can be logically inferred from the above statements?

I. Social science disciplines have become obsolete.

II. Social science disciplines had a pre-colonial origin.

III. Social science disciplines always promote colonialism.

IV. Social science must maintain disciplinary boundaries.

A II only

B I and III only

C II and IV only

D III and IV only

#Q.11 The overwhelming number of people infected with rabies in India has been-flagged by the World Health Organization as a source of concern. It is estimated that inoculating 70 of pets and stray dogs against rabies can lead to a significant reduction in the number of people infected with rabies.

Which of the following can be logically inferred from the above sentences?

A The number of people in India infected with rabies is high.

B The number of people in other parts of the world who are infected with rabies is low

C Rabies can be eradicated in India by vaccinating 70 of stray dogs

D Stray dogs are the main source of rabies worldwide

#Q.12 Choose the most appropriate word from the options given below to complete the following sentence. If the athlete had wanted to come first in the race, he several hours every day.

A Should practice

B Should have practiced

C Practiced

D Should be practicing

#Q.13 In the following question, the first and the last sentence of the passage are in order and numbered 1 and 6 . The rest of the passage is split into 4 parts and numbered as 2,3,4 and 5 . These 4 parts are not arranged in proper order. Read the sentences and arrange them in a logical sequence to make a passage and choose the correct sequence from the given options.

1. On Diwali, the family rises early in the morning.
2. The whole family, including :he young and the old enjoy doing this.
3. Children let off fireworks later in the night with their friends.
4. At sunset, the lamps are lit and the family performs various rituals.
5. Father, mother and children visit relatives and exchange gifts and sweets.
6. Houses looks so pretty with lighted lamps all around.

A 2,5,3,4

B 5,2,4,3

C 3,5,4,2

D 4,5,2,3

#Q.14 Lamenting the gradual sidelining of the arts in school curricula, a group of prominent artists wrote to the Chief Minister last year, asking him to allocate more funds to support arts education in schools. However, no such increase has been announced in this year's Budget. The artists expressed their deep anguish at their request not being approved, but many of them remain optimistic about finding in the future, Which of the statement(s) below is/are logically valid and can be inferred from the above statements?

(i) The artists expected funding for the arts to increase this year.

(ii) The Chief Minister was receptive to the idea of increasing funding for the arts.

(iii) The Chief Minister is a prominent artists.

(iv) Schools are giving less importance to arts education nowadays.

A (iii) and (iv)

B (i) and (iv)

C (i), (ii) and (iv)

D (i) and (iii)



2 mins Summary

- Topic One
- Topic Two
- Topic Three
- Topic Four
- Topic Five

Adverb
Preposition
Verb
Adjective
Questions

THANK - YOU

